

Brown Box which was a gaming console system designed to play one type of game by connecting to the television. Atari also released games like Virtual pinball and Pong. And these consoles were hugely successful. Consoles like Magnavox depended on a plastic sheet with 'graphics' printed on it that would overlay on the TV screen. Then the three bits on the screen could be controlled by knobs and games could be played. The gaming industry was very different back then. The first console to use a cartridge



The ATARI 2600 with some of the most selling cartridges.

system was the Fairchild Channel F. Atari also drew inspiration for this and made their first in home console system called the Atari 2600. The console could be used to played games like Combat and Pac-Man with the use of ROM-based cartridges which would contain the code needed to make a game run.

A lot of companies took inspiration from these companies and released their own versions of games designed to be played at home. So in a way,

the first instance of game distribution would be the cartridges which gave the consumers a chance to play games like Pac-Man, Space Invaders and Pitfall.

E.T. was also released for the Atari 2600 in cartridge based format only. The drawback of this was that the companies had to manufacture all these cartridges without knowing how much demand there would be. It was risky business. However, Atari, Sega and many more companies made a lot of money through selling these cartridges.

THE GOLDEN AGE OF GAMING

Everything that happened throughout the '70s made gaming evolve into a massive industry. Activision became the first third party vendor to seek profits for the games they developed that would be played on various consoles. This was truly a drastic shift, in the favour of gaming distribution. A lot of new consoles and innovative games were coming up. For the first time, 3D games were designed – Battlezone being the first. All this while, the